Handoff 18: Backlog sync after PRs #19 to #22 (BACKLOG-SYNC-2)

Date: 2026-10-27 (America/Toronto)
Written by: Claude Code (implementer)
For: the human maintainer, and ChatGPT or Claude chat (reviewer) without repository access
Status: **in_review**: one pull request (#23), documentation only, not merged. Nothing is marked `verified`.

> **How to use this file:** upload it with `docs/plan/backlog.md`, handoff 12 (`2026-10-26-12-admin-role.md`) and handoff 15 (`2026-10-27-15-lesson-feedback.md`). The pull request diff is the source of truth (`build.md` section 14).

Starter prompt for the chat assistant

```
You are reviewing a documentation-only update to Python Academy's backlog
(docs/plan/backlog.md) after four pull requests were merged: #19 (site
design), #20 (the first backlog sync), #21 (admin and tester roles, FB-01)
and #22 (lesson feedback engine part 1, ENG-04). I'm attaching the
backlog, handoffs 12 and 15 and this handoff. Check every status against
the handoffs, check that nothing is marked verified without a recorded
live check, check that the status words are build.md's (proposed, ready,
in_progress, in_review, verified, blocked, deferred), and point out
anything stale that this update left alone.
```

1. Step 0 (checks before editing)

Check	Result
`git fetch --all`, `gh pr list --state all`	Done
PR #19 (SITE-01)	Merged 2026-10-27 04:32 UTC; its head commit is in `origin/main`
PR #20 (BACKLOG-SYNC)	Merged 2026-10-27 05:13 UTC; head in `origin/main`
PR #21 (FB-01)	Merged 2026-10-27 05:13 UTC; head in `origin/main`
PR #22 (ENG-04 part 1)	Merged 2026-10-27 05:19 UTC; head in `origin/main`
Branch	`docs/backlog-sync-2` from `origin/main` at `b74acfd`

2. Handoff record (build.md template)

Field	Value
Task	BACKLOG-SYNC-2: bring `docs/plan/backlog.md` up to date with PRs #19, #21 and #22, record the owner's answers to handoff 15 section 12, and update the owed live checks
Human goal	The backlog shows what is merged, what still needs a live check, and what comes next, without claiming anything is verified
Relevant sections	`build.md` sections 13, 14 and 18 (status words)
Repository and branch	`torontojohn/python-academy`, branch `docs/backlog-sync-2`
Base commit	`b74acfd` (`main` after PR #22)
Implementer / reviewer	Claude Code / the owner and a chat assistant
Files changed	`docs/plan/backlog.md`; this handoff (`.md` and `.pdf`)
Non-goals	Any code, any other plan file, marking anything `verified`, and items the task did not list (section 6)
Data migration / compatibility	None
Deployment status	Not requested. Documentation only

3. What changed in `docs/plan/backlog.md`

Where	Change
Header	Last updated 2026-10-27; decision 14 answered on 2026-10-26, decisions 24 to 27 on 2026-10-27
Stage table	**Stage 12, FB-01** added: in_review: merged (PR #21, handoff 12); live check owed. **Stage 13, SITE-01**: in_review: merged (PR #19, handoff 13; documentation only). **Stage 15, ENG-04 part 1** added: in_review: merged (PR #22, handoff 15); live check owed. The sentence "There is no stage 12…" was removed, because stage 12 now exists
Live checks still owed	(a) SEC-03, (b) ASSESS-07 and the SEC-09 line kept, because none is recorded yet. **(c) FB-01** added: migration 0007 in the logs, 401 signed out, 403 for a student, admin session ends after 1 hour unused. **(d) ENG-04 part 1** added: the ten checks of handoff 15 section 10
FB-01	in_review: merged (PR #21, handoff 12); live check owed, section 1 (c)
FB-03	in_review: merged (PR #21), with handoff 12 section 8's note: the guard and the route-enumeration tests are delivered; the inbox routes remain

Where	Change
FB-04	Note: the API exists (`GET /api/admin/students`, `POST /api/admin/testers`), the page does not. Status stays proposed
ENG-04	in_review: merged (PR #22, handoff 15); live check owed, section 1 (d)
ENG-04b (new)	proposed. Copied from handoff 15 section 11, plus the hint-button outline (decision 25)
ASSESS-08 (new)	proposed. The unit 1 hint rewording from handoff 15 section 11, done as part of ENG-04b (decision 27)
UI-05	Note added: it must call `check-runner.js` from the lesson page for lessons with browser checks
Decision 14	Answered: `ADMIN_EMAILS`, verified Google emails, decided at sign-in, re-checked on every request (2026-10-26)
Decisions 24 to 27 (new)	The owner's answers to handoff 15 section 12 (section 4 below)

The status words used are `build.md`'s: `in_review` (with "merged" as a note) and `proposed`. Nothing is `verified`.

4. Decisions and why

Decision	Options considered	Reason	Who decided
24: the friendly message first in every unit; revisit around unit 6	Python's message first from unit 6 (`lesson-feedback.md` decision 2)	Owner's answer	Owner, 2026-10-27
25: highlight the hint button after two failed runs, as a gentle outline, in ENG-04b	Never highlight it (`lesson-feedback.md` decision 3)	Owner's answer	Owner, 2026-10-27
26: assumptions 1 to 3 of handoff 15 accepted	Change any of them	Owner's answer	Owner, 2026-10-27
27: unit 1 hints reworded in ENG-04b	Leave them	Owner's answer	Owner, 2026-10-27
The answers became **decisions 24 to 27** in the backlog's decision table	A note inside the ENG-04 row; numbering them 2 to 5 as in `lesson-feedback.md`	The backlog's numbers continue one sequence (header note), and `lesson-feedback.md`'s own numbers 1 to 5 would clash with decisions 1 to 5 in `course-catalog.md`. Each row names the `lesson-feedback.md` decision it answers	Implementer (**assumption 1**)

Decision	Options considered	Reason	Who decided
The hint-rewording item is **ASSESS-08**	EDU-11 (the next free EDU number); the "EDU-xx" placeholder in handoff 15	ASSESS-07 already rewrote unit 1 hints, so this is the same kind of work. EDU-11 was once a draft ID for video scripts (handoff 16), so reusing it could confuse	Implementer (**assumption 2**)
Stage 13 (documentation only) is `in_review: merged`, not `verified`	`verified`, as earlier documentation stages were marked	The task: "Do not mark anything verified"	Owner's instruction

5. Bugs found and how they were fixed

No bugs found. One near-miss: the stage table said "There is no stage 12", which would have contradicted the new stage 12 row. It was found while editing, and the sentence was removed.

6. Left alone on purpose (the task said "add nothing else")

These lines are now **stale**, but the task did not list them, so they are unchanged. Tell me if you want them in a follow-up:

- **Stage 11 (ENG-03)** and the **ENG-03** row still say "in_review (PR #17, handoff 11)". PR #17 is merged.
- **Stage 14** and the **DOC-01** and **DOC-02** rows still say "in_review (PR #18, handoff 14)". PR #18 is merged.
- The **SITE-01** row still says "in_review (PR #19, handoff 13)", without "merged". Only the stage table was listed.
- Section 2, "Suggested order", item 6 still says ENG-03 is "in review, PR #17", and item 4 does not mention that FB-01 is merged.
- Section 3's admin paragraph still says decision 14 is "proposed". Only the decision table was listed.

7. How it was tested

Check	Command	Result
Relative links	A small script reads every `[...](...)` link in `backlog.md` and checks that the file and the heading anchor exist	3 links, **0 broken**
File names in backticks	The same script checks every file name in backticks (`.md`, `.py`, `.js`, `.ts`, `.tsx`, `.yaml`, `.json`)	18 names, **0 missing**
Backend, SQLite	`cd backend && DATABASE_URL=sqlite:///<temp>.db .venv/bin/python -m pytest -q`	**282 passed, 10 skipped**

Check	Command	Result
Backend, PostgreSQL 16	Same with `TEST_POSTGRES_URL=<local pgserver>`	**292 passed**
Frontend	`cd frontend && npx tsc --noEmit && npm run build && CI=1 npx playwright test`	Types and build OK; **83 passed**

- The suites prove that this documentation change broke nothing. They say nothing about the backlog's content, which is reviewed by reading it.
- **Mocks:** none added. Browser tests mock API answers, as before.
- **Deliberate-break controls:** none. There is no code to break; the link check is the only automated check on this file.

8. Live checks for you

There is nothing to deploy. The backlog now lists the owed live checks in one place (section 1, "Live checks still owed"):

- [ ] **(a)** SEC-03: logout revokes the session (handoff 07 section 10).
- [ ] **(b)** ASSESS-07: `print("hi")` twice no longer passes "Open the story".
- [ ] SEC-09: the nonce headers and the console checks (handoff 08 section 10).
- [ ] **(c)** FB-01:
- migration 0007 in the API logs
- 401 signed out
- 403 for a student
- the admin session ends after 1 hour unused
- [ ] **(d)** ENG-04 part 1: the ten checks of handoff 15 section 10.

When you have run one, tell me the date and what you saw, and it can move to `verified` in the next sync.

To review this PR: open `docs/plan/backlog.md` on the branch and read section 1, the FB, ENG-04 and ASSESS-08 rows, and decisions 14 and 24 to 27.

9. Known limitations and questions

1. **Assumption 1:** are decisions 24 to 27 the right place and numbers for your answers?
2. **Assumption 2:** is ASSESS-08 the right ID for the hint rewording?
3. **Stale lines** (section 6): update them in a follow-up?
4. **ENG-04b's position:** it is listed as before EDU-04 (unit 2), as handoff 15 proposed. EDU-04's "Depends on" column was not changed to add it.

10. Next concrete action

Review and merge this PR. Then run live checks (c) and (d), and record the results so FB-01 and ENG-04 can move to `verified`. FB-02 can start now that FB-01 is merged.